Robert Guss

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Frontend Developer with over eight years of experience building scalable web applications using modern best practices and technologies. Expertise includes React, TypeScript, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, and Cypress. Demonstrated ability to collaborate with product teams, deliver customer-centric solutions, and improve developer experience through documentation and training initiatives. Experienced mentor and educator, having taught over 50,000 developers at howtocode.io.

SKILLS

React | Vue.js | XState | HTML | CSS | JavaScript |TypeScript | Tailwind CSS | Next.js | Git | Cypress | Python | PHP | Node.js | Docker | Linux | WordPress | Agile/Scrum | Mobile Optimization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer | December 2014 - Current
Freelance/Contractor | Remote

- Design & develop custom sites and applications using a variety of technologies (WordPress, Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, PHP, MySQL)
- Develop custom WordPress themes (PHP, Timber/Twig, Advanced Custom Fields, Pods, Custom Post Type UI)
- Update and maintain existing WordPress themes and sites
- Extensive experience with a variety of WordPress plugins, tools, and the WordPress ecosystem
- Custom integrations with 3rd party APIs and services
- Extensive experience optimizing sites for overall performance, page speed, SEO, image optimization, etc.

Senior Frontend Engineer and Solutions Engineer | March 2023 - January 2024
Airplane Labs | Remote

Recently acquired by Airtable, Airplane is a platform for building UIs and internal tools for engineering, support, and operations teams.

- Developed responsive landing pages for airplane.dev (including the landing page used to launch on Product Hunt) using Next.js, TypeScript, and Tailwind CSS, increasing user signups and demos booked by 25%
- Developed and implemented customized views, tasks, and templates using React, TypeScript, Python, and SQL to expedite customer onboarding and optimize processes, resulting in 3-6 hours saved for each customer engagement
- Redesigned documentation information architecture, prioritizing accessibility and streamlined navigation for all user levels to accelerate onboarding
- Spearheaded customer training and technical support processes, achieving an average response time of under 8 minutes

Senior Frontend Engineer and Developer Experience Engineer | April 2021 - September 2022
Cypress.io | Remote

- Co-authored the Real World Testing with Cypress curriculum, used by over 20,000 thousand developers globally, to advance industry-standard testing practices (Next.js, MDX, Xstate, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS)
- Increased developer adoption and engagement by over 20% through instructional videos, tutorials, and example apps
- Drove improvement in documentation accessibility by restructuring information architecture for new component testing features and leading the migration to Docusaurus; resulting in enhanced developer onboarding and a 20%

reduction in customer support volume
- Maintained GitHub Action, CircleCI Orb, and the "Real World App," improving developer experience by saving 2-4 hours for users
- Accelerated the launch of Cypress component testing through rigorous testing, debugging, and API design guidance by creating demos and examples apps
- Collaborated on the website redesign (www.cypress.io), developing new landing pages to enhance user experience, lead generation by 20%, and brand messaging

Senior Software Engineer | December 2018 - April 2021
InsureMyTrip | Remote

- Led the initiative to revamp front-end tooling for a 10-member engineering team, resulting in an increase in code quality and developer productivity by 20% through the modernization of tooling and processes
- Drove cultural shift toward automated testing, accelerating developer onboarding, and minimizing customer-facing issues and bugs by 33%
- Partnered with product managers and UX to design and launch a customer-centric quote form, enhancing the travel insurance purchase process, reducing development and QA time by 40%

Web Developer | June 2017 - December 2018
DNL OmniMedia | Remote

- Led the design and development of websites and applications for nonprofits, delivering responsive and user-centric experiences tailored to drive business goals
- Architected scalable front-end build systems for clients, streamlining development workflows and reducing time-to-market by 30%

Front-End Developer | May 2015 - June 2017
inMusic Brands | Cumberland, RI

- Led front-end development across a portfolio of 14+ company websites, ensuring brand consistency, accessibility, and optimal user experience
- Built high-converting microsites and landing pages for product launches, increasing lead generation and campaign ROI
- Developed cross-client compatible, responsive HTML emails, contributing to a significant improvement in open rates by 30%

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Music | Magna Cum Laude | May 2013
Berklee College of Music | Boston, MA